

Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans:

Regular physical activity is one of the most important actions people can take to improve their overall health. The CDC and U.S. Department of Health and Human Services recommend distinct weekly targets for aerobic and muscle-strengthening activities for adults.

Adult Aerobic Activity Target (Ages 18-64):

For substantial health benefits, adults should achieve one of the following benchmarks:

- Option 1 (Moderate Intensity): At least 150 minutes (2 hours and 30 minutes) to 300 minutes of moderate-intensity physical activity per week. Examples include brisk walking (at least 2.5 to 3.0 mph), leisure cycling, water aerobics, and active gardening.
 - Option 2 (Vigorous Intensity): At least 75 minutes (1 hour and 15 minutes) to 150 minutes of vigorous-intensity physical activity per week. Examples include running, jogging, swimming laps, singles tennis, and fast cycling.
 - Option 3: An equivalent combination of moderate and vigorous aerobic activity.
- Spread activity throughout the week rather than concentrating it into a single day.

Muscle-Strengthening and Sedentary Behavior:

In addition to aerobic activity, adults should also participate in:

- Muscle-Strengthening Activities: Involving all major muscle groups (legs, hips, back, abdomen, chest, shoulders, and arms) on 2 or more days per week. Examples include lifting weights, working with resistance bands, bodyweight exercises (push-ups, sit-ups, squats), and heavy yard work.
- Reducing Sedentary Time: Adults should move more and sit less throughout the day. Some physical activity is better than none.

Demonstrated Health Benefits:

Immediate Benefits (Single Session):

- Improves sleep quality and reduces daytime fatigue
- Reduces acute anxiety symptoms
- Improves insulin sensitivity and transiently lowers blood pressure

Long-Term Benefits:

- Significantly lowers risk of cardiovascular disease, stroke, hypertension, and type 2 diabetes
- Reduces risk of 8 types of cancer (bladder, breast, colon, endometrium, esophagus, kidney, lung, stomach)
- Enhances bone mineral density and physical functional capacity
- Decreases risk of fall-related injuries in older adults